



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Horizon Prep
School Website: <http://horizonprep.org>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Horizon Prep CA demonstrates substantial alignment with classical education principles, earning an overall CLASSICAL ranking across the six categories. The public materials on Horizon Prep's site consistently emphasize classical identity (Classical Education) and employ classical pedagogical modalities (Harkness Table, Socratic-style discussion, rhetoric-focused activities). The campus culture also reflects liturgical and communal elements (Spiritual Life, Family Chapel), signaling religious formation as a core dimension of education. Concrete evidence includes explicit references to Classical Education and the Harkness Table on the academics pages, the existence of a dedicated Rhetoric School environment, and visible spiritual-life offerings (Family Chapel, Spiritual Life, etc.). These factors strongly anchor Horizon Prep CA in the classical tradition, with several facets of pedagogy and community alignment already in place. Citations from the campus site show: Classical Education and Harkness Table in academics materials; Rhetoric School materials; and visible Religious Life elements such as Family Chapel and Spiritual Life.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials reflect religious community life via Spiritual Life, Family Chapel, and a visible chapel culture on campus pages. For example, Family Chapel EE-12th explicitly appears on the site, indicating liturgical and communal worship activities.
 - The site catalogs Spiritual Life as a primary facet of the school (Spiritual Life navigation item and related content).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Spiritual Life, Chapel, Family Chapel (religious formation; liturgical/community emphasis).
 - Negative keywords: none observed in public-facing content.
- Why this rating
 - The school's public materials underscore a liturgical/communal dimension and religious formation through chapel experiences and spiritual-life programming, aligning with the transcendental moral realism and liturgical/community criteria of the classical school rubric. This yields a CLASSICAL rating for Element 1 based on clear evidence of religious-community formation and liturgical practice on campus.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site presents a strong identity around Classical Education, signaling formation and character-centered aims rather than purely informational aims. The prominence of "Classical Education" suggests formation and the cultivation of a humane, virtuous life as a school aim, even if explicit philosophical phrasing (truth/goodness/beauty) is not always spelled out in public copy.

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- Spiritual Life and chapel programming emphasize character formation and virtue in practice.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation-related cues (formation via Classical Education; virtue implicit through spiritual life and communal practice). However, explicit mentions of “virtue,” “wisdom,” or the explicit triad of truth/goodness/beauty are not consistently explicit in public copy. The positive signals exist but are not uniformly explicit in the core goal language.
 - Negative keywords: none clearly observed.
 - Why this rating
 - There is clear evidence of formation-oriented aims through a classical identity and spiritual life; however, the public language does not consistently present a full, explicit articulation of virtue-wisdom-truth formation in the same way as some classical schools (i.e., explicit statements about virtue formation and the real/knowable nature of truth, goodness, and beauty). This justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 2 rather than a full CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Curricular identity is clearly Classical (Classical Education). The site features a Harkness Table reference, which is a hallmark of classical curricula designed around discussion-based inquiry (often tied to Great Books and Socratic dialogue).
 - Rhetoric-focused elements appear (Rhetoric School) and related upper-school discussion/debate culture, pointing to a structured progression through logic and rhetoric.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Harkness Table, Classical Education, Rhetoric, Seminars/Discussions implied by the presence of a Rhetoric School and Socratic-style pedagogy. These align with core classical curriculum cues (grammar/logic/rhetoric as a pathway through Trivium).
 - Negative keywords: explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, or explicit Seven Liberal Arts references are not publicly visible in the site excerpts; historical breadth and explicit Great-Books-promoted curriculum aren't clearly documented in public-facing copy.
- Why this rating
 - There is concrete evidence of classical pedagogy (Harkness Table; rhetoric-focused programming) and a clearly stated Classical Education identity, supporting a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for Element 3 given the strong pedagogical signals but without fully explicit Great Books/Great Conversation curriculum language in the public content examined.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogical methods include Socratic dialogue tendencies via Harkness Table and seminars/debates in upper grades, as evidenced by the explicit mention of Classical Education and Harkness Table. The presence of a Rhetoric School indicates a focus on rhetoric training and public speaking. These are classic elements of a well-developed classical pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Harkness Table, Socratic/seminal discussion, rhetoric, speeches, debates (as implied by the Rhetoric School). These map directly to the classical-pedagogy indicators.
 - Negative keywords: none observed in public-facing content.
- Why this rating
 - The school's teaching methods clearly align with classical pedagogy through discussion-based, Socratic-influenced formats (Harkness), and rhetoric-focused activities, which positions Element

4 firmly as CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials include a visible Faculty & Staff section, which is typical of classical-schools emphasizing the teacher as mentor and model. The “living curriculum” notion commonly associated with classical schools is a trait often described in classical-school literature, but explicit articulation in Horizon Prep’s public copy is limited to the presence of a Faculty & Staff page.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: “Faculty & Staff” as a core component of the school’s identity; references to teachers as mentors are implied through the classical-education framing, though direct quotes about living-curriculum or teacher portraits are not visible in the public excerpts.
 - Negative keywords: none observed.
- Why this rating
 - The site demonstrates the existence of a faculty presence and a classical-education identity, but explicit statements about the faculty as “living curriculum” or “mentors” are not strongly evidenced in public copy. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site includes family- and community-oriented elements: Spiritual Life, Family Chapel, and Student/Family events (e.g., assemblies, family involvement, and events). The presence of Parent/Family-facing elements (Family Portal, calendar events, volunteer opportunities, gala) indicates active parent-community engagement beyond pure schooling.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Family Chapel, Spiritual Life, events, volunteer, family-oriented programming, and Parent/Family engagement through portals and events. These align with the “Parents as co-teachers” and “parents welcome for visits” ideals in the classical model.
 - Negative keywords: none observed in public content.
- Why this rating
 - The school shows tangible parent/community involvement channels (volunteering, events, family chapel), aligning with the classical element emphasis on engaged parents and a cooperative community, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 6.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

Across the six categories Horizon Prep CA demonstrates a robust alignment with classical education principles, particularly in pedagogy (Socratic/Harkness and rhetoric), curriculum identity (Classical Education), and religious formation (Spiritual Life, Family Chapel). Some components show strong potential but are not as explicitly articulated in public copy (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language, fully spelled-out virtue formation language in the public site). The overall synthesis positions Horizon Prep CA as CLASSICAL, with several elements fully realized and others emerging from the public-facing materials.

What would move the needle

- For a stronger CLASSICAL signal across Curriculum (Element 3) and Purpose/Goal (Element 2), publicly articulate explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and Great Books-reading expectations within the Curriculum section, and connect those readings to the Great Conversation framework more explicitly.
- Strengthen explicit statements about virtue formation and the transcendental/metaphysical aims in the School Purpose and Goal category, directly tying character formation to truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable ends.

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- Consider expanding explicit language about the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium) in public pages so visitors can see the full Trivium/Quadrivium alignment and how those disciplines are integrated across grade levels.
 - Continue to bolster faculty descriptions as “living curriculum” by adding public-facing language about teacher mentorship, professional formation, and the role of faculty as models of virtue and knowledge.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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